

Designing for Real People

Projects Milestones & Assessment Criteria

IMPERIAL



Royal College of Art
Postgraduate Art and Design

Milestone 0 : pre-pitch project framing

*“Getting off to a good start. **What** is your project about and **why** does it matter?”*

We recommend that you choose a project area that you're inspired by, passionate about and where you have access to the people involved!
As a group, to help you prepare for the Milestone 1 elevator pitch,

Use the **DRP Playbook/Week 1** to guide you through the process, allowing you to clearly articulate what you're focusing on and how much you understand about the context and problem.

The context and knowledge base - Your area of interest and focus e.g. food charity (the place, the people, the story). What knowledge and expertise do you have to successfully work on this project? What access to users/stakeholders do you have to test and develop ideas? What potential ideas and resources do you have that will help you develop a meaningful digital touchpoint?

The people - i.e. specific details around your target audience and other stakeholders in the context who are connected in some way to the challenge area e.g. food charity worker, volunteers in the system etc. The richer and more detailed the personas presented, the better.

Evidence - tangible “data” that you have gathered that is the basis for your project. Data in design terms is more qualitative, preferably, first-hand sources: think people, not numbers. This type of data leads to authentic and rich insights and analysis and usually only requires working with a few, well-chosen people who are relevant to the context being explored.

Insight and analysis - the specific observations and meaning drawn from the evidence - the key statements and research you have done based on your data. The people you're designing for are usually not consciously aware of these until you present your analysis to them.

Problem Statement - what's your challenge statement based on the above evidence
e.g.

“Hundreds of thousands of tonnes of good food is wasted by the UK food industry every year. At the same time, millions of people are struggling to afford to eat. This food charity addresses these 2 issues by redistributing food industry surplus which would otherwise go to waste, to the people who need it most. Volunteers are key in helping to distribute food to charities. However, project managers are struggling to effectively manage the supply and demand of these volunteers.”

‘How Might we..’ question - a succinct description of the challenge you will address
e.g.

“How Might We... enable food charity project managers to strengthen and efficiently organise their volunteers in order to create a vibrant and reliable volunteer network whilst reaching increasing numbers of people in need”. Some early ideas may emerge from this towards a digital touchpoint.

The Clinic Hours in the first week will be held at 14.00 - 16.00 on Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday - do come along to talk through your thinking and asking any questions to the IC and RCA team.

Milestone 1: Project Inception (5%)

*Elevator Pitch - communicating the **ambition** and **excitement** of your project idea.*

For this week, we are expecting you to have chosen a topic for your project, explored that context through research and formulated a problem statement and 'How Might We..' question for your project. This will be presented as a **pre-recorded 3-minute elevator-pitch micro-presentation**.

Context, problem and storytelling (who/what/when/where/why/how?)			
No context or missing important elements. Focus is internal. e.g. team only / stuck in comfort zone	Some context, but in a vague scenario without a clear need. Focus is limited. e.g family, friends, colleagues	Clear context, scenario and need, but focused on only a single stakeholder group.	Rich context, with tangible access to diverse stakeholder groups.
People and personas (the actors who bring the experience to life)			
No real people.	Real, but overly abstracted or lacking authenticity.	Well-defined characters/personas, but poorly integrated into pitch.	Well-defined characters/personas used to drive narrative.
Evidence: a range of data that illustrates a real challenge and the potential value of the project			
Nothing. i.e. No data to back up the premise of the project.	Weak evidence. e.g. Hearsay, assumptions, static survey/interview, generic facts/figures, or data analysed only by a third party.	Strong evidence from real people, gathered via interactive HCD techniques.	Strong evidence, as previous, providing powerful qualitative arguments, linked with well-referenced third-party statistics.
Insights and analysis			
Overly generic or "cliche" observations. e.g. "time is money".	Specific observations, but lacking authenticity of hypothesis.	Specific and authentic observations, but lacking clear impact or value.	Insightful and empathetic observations, with high impact and potential value.
Opportunity statement (what need(s) are you solving for?)			
Missing or minimal statement.	High-level, abstract statement overly focused on problem, technology, or lacking depth/detail.	Clear "how might we" statement, but lacking completeness, ambition or benefit to users.	Clear "how might we" statement covering impact for all stakeholder groups. Ambitious and interesting.

Milestone 2: Concept Development (5%)

Milestone Review Session - discussing your project progress and receiving feedback

For this week, we are expecting you to have a visual representation of the mock-ups you have created for your digital touchpoint and to have tested these with real people to validate your ideas through high quality feedback. We also expect to see evidence of continuous deployment of the initial “walking-skeleton” prototype for the project’s digital touchpoint.

Visual representation of digital touchpoint (mock-ups for real people)			
No physical form.	Generic, abstract, static interface, or unfocused site-map.	Meaningful mock-up, but lacks interaction or core focus.	Meaningful mock-ups with clear interlinked core interaction.
How have real people interacted with the paper mock-up?			
No real or significant interaction.	Only static or high-level feedback. e.g. e-mail, survey, WhatsApp or online message boards.	Interactive feedback gathered, building upon static, but lacking clarity or focus in its presentation.	Rich multidimensional and interactive feedback, presented via relevant excerpts.
Quality of feedback and validation of the concept			
Nothing that helps guide the design or development of the project’s digital touchpoint.	Some surface-level, superficial engagement with users. e.g. focus on font/colour/layout rather than interactions.	Detailed discussion and user engagement with digital touchpoint, but lacking focus or context of use.	Deep discussion with users about how the digital touchpoint would work in reality. Might lead to interaction with additional stakeholder groups.
Preparing development process for digital touchpoint			
Git repository set-up.	Functioning CI build system.	Full public deployment.	Functioning CD system.
Preparing a walking skeleton for digital touchpoint			
Chosen tech-stack for future application development.	Current state is a generic hello-world, todo, map or login application.	Current state is context-specific, but lacks any context-relevant interaction.	Current state prototypes a core context-relevant interaction of your digital touchpoint.

Milestone 3: Iterative Development (5%)

Milestone Review Session - discussing your project progress and receiving feedback

For this week, we are expecting you to have developed a context-relevant digital touchpoint for your project, have shown this to real users and received high quality feedback. We also expect to see evidence of agile sprint planning, driven by user stories, and thin slicing of feature development.

Sprint planning			
No clear design or development planning in place.	Evidence of agile workflow (e.g. project board), but development not informed by user stories.	Clear evidence of agile -and- user-centred development in presentation of sprint's planning.	As previous, but current sprint's planning is also clearly framed in wider user journey.
Digital touchpoint (designed for real people)			
Generic, abstract, static interface, or unfocused site-map, likely developed from static feedback.	Meaningful design, but lacking context-relevant interactions.	Meaningful design with helpful, context-relevant interactions.	An engaging application, rich with meaningful and usable context-relevant interactions.
How have real people interacted with the digital touchpoint			
Only static or high-level feedback. e.g. e-mail, survey, WhatsApp or online message boards.	Interactive feedback gathered, building upon static, but lacking clarity or focus in its presentation.	Rich multidimensional and interactive feedback, presented via relevant excerpts.	Rich multidimensional feedback and application of clear/specific customised HCD data gathering methods in sessions with users.
Quality of feedback and validation of the idea			
Nothing that helps guide the design or development of the project's digital touchpoint.	Some surface-level, superficial engagement with users. e.g. focus on font/colour/layout rather than interactions.	Detailed discussion and user engagement with digital touchpoint, but lacking focus or context of use.	Feedback provides a clear direction for the digital touchpoint towards being useful and helpful for a wide range of stakeholder groups.
Thin slicing development			
No evidence of thin slicing. i.e. skewed development on Front-End, Back-End, or DB.	Evidence of partial thin slicing or a single thin slice in this sprint's project progress.	Clear evidence of thin slicing, but favouring volume of features over refinement of specific interactions.	Clear evidence of distinct thin slices in ongoing development and refinement of specific interactions.

Milestone 4: More Iterative Development (5%)

Milestone Review Session - discussing your project progress and receiving feedback

For this week, we are expecting you to have shown your project's digital touchpoint to real users and gotten more high-quality feedback on a more complete user experience. We also expect to see further evidence of agile sprint planning, driven by user stories, and thin slicing of feature development. Additionally, we want you to consider the potential impact of your project and quantitatively evaluate the success of your end-product.

Sprint planning			
No clear design or development planning in place.	Evidence of agile workflow (e.g. project board), but development not informed by user stories.	Clear evidence of agile -and- user-centred development in presentation of sprint's planning.	As previous, but current sprint's planning is also clearly framed in wider user journey.
Digital touchpoint (designed for real people)			
Generic, abstract, static interface, or unfocused site-map, likely developed from static feedback.	Meaningful design, but lacking context-relevant interactions.	Meaningful design with helpful, context-relevant interactions.	An engaging application, rich with meaningful and usable context-relevant interactions.
Quality of feedback and validation of the idea			
Nothing that helps guide the design or development of the project's digital touchpoint.	Some surface-level, superficial engagement with users. e.g. focus on font/colour/layout rather than interactions.	Detailed discussion and user engagement with digital touchpoint, but lacking focus or context of use.	Feedback provides a clear direction for the digital touchpoint towards being useful and helpful for a wide range of stakeholder groups.
Designing for positive wider impact - impact asset			
Potential impact of project not considered or demonstrated via HCD techniques.	Potential impact demonstrated via HCD techniques. e.g. cover story mock-up, poster	Compelling vision and impact of the project proposition, but lacking consideration of wider positive consequences.	Compelling vision and impact of the project proposition, including consideration of wider positive consequences.
Quantitative and objective evaluation			
No metric or objective evaluation provided.	Some generic metric collected, but with limited relevance or poor analysis of observations.	Meaningful metric collected, but with limited analysis or little/no comparison with iterations across the week.	Meaningful metric collected, with good analysis and comparison with iterations across the week.

Final Project Evaluation (50%)

Presentation & Demonstration - showing off what you have achieved during the project

For this week, we are expecting you to present your work/project, illustrating a compelling scenario that illustrates the value of your digital touchpoint, designed for real people. You should provide evidence that real people have interacted with the digital touchpoint, and demonstrate that you have captured useful, deep engagement and feedback from these stakeholders.

Quality of Presentation				
	Good Pacing / Clear Articulation	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Clean, Clear and Consistent Slides	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	Ran to Time	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Sensible Use of Diagrams/Images	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	Emotive Presentation	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Demo integrated with presentation	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
Presentation Content				
Story Telling:	Quantitative evidence / background research	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Qualitative evidence / real user stories	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
The Problem:	Clear Problem Statement	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Real-World Evidence-Driven Problem	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	Well-defined Target Audience	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Distinct User Testing Iterations	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
User Experience:	Relevant Stakeholder Groups Considered	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Seamless In-app User Experience	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	Seamless In-context User Experience	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Navigable UI	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
Technical Quality:	Justified Language/Framework Choice	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	User to User Interactions	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	Effective System Architecture Diagram	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Responsive User Interactions	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
			Stable Product	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
Conclusion and Evaluation:	What Went Well?	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	User Impact/Benefits	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
	What Would You Do Differently?	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐	Future Work	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐

Project Documentation (20%)

Light-Weight Report - advertise your project and discuss its legal context and your design process

You should prepare a small portfolio of documents* that detail certain specific aspects of your DRP group project. We expect that the bulk of the content will have been developed during the project and that your documentation submission just provides some narrative.

You will need to provide the following documents:

1. **Project Pitch Leaflet (10%)**
2. **Copyright/Legal Issues Report (10%)**
3. **Human Centred Design Techniques Portfolio (80%)**

There are more details on the specific requirements of each document over the following three pages.

**With the exception of the Human Centred Design Techniques Portfolio, each of these documents should be no more than a single side of an A4 page. The Human Centred Design Techniques Report will vary in length depending on the quantity of evidence and support material that you include, but the discussion itself should be limited to a single side of an A4 page. You are encouraged to use diagrams to convey information (where possible).*

1. Project Pitch Leaflet

Create a leaflet that sums up the purpose and use of your digital touchpoint. The leaflet should include a logo, product name, a short description of the value proposition and an example screen-shot of the digital touchpoint that communicates a key user journey and how it solves a particular problem (highlighting the before and after). You might also want to visualise the context of use of the digital touchpoint in some fashion. The idea of this leaflet is to generate interest to its target audience in the context of a tech fair or publicity event.

Project Pitch Leaflet			
Missing project name, or name overly generic	☐	Clearly displays good choice of project name	☐
Missing, generic or unhelpful screen-shot/mock-up	☐	Well chosen and emotive screen-shot/mock-up	☐
Missing or vague problem statement	☐	Clear and concise problem-statement	☐
Missing or vague target-audience	☐	Clear and specific target-audience	☐
Missing or vague solution proposition	☐	Clear and specific solution proposed	☐

2. Copyright/Legal Issues Report

In a list or table you should acknowledge any libraries, code or pictures that are used in your final digital touchpoint and have not been written or created by your group. In a short paragraph you should also briefly discuss any legal issues that you would have to consider if you were to officially release your digital touchpoint. This document should be suitable for a future development team to understand the legal constraints placed upon them within the scope of continuing work on this project.

Copyright/Legal Issues Report			
Missing or incomplete resource/license list	☐	Clear list of all third-party resources & licenses	☐
Resource ↔ License links not clear	☐	Resources and their licenses clearly linked	☐
License legal implications not understood	☐	License legal implications well-considered	☐
Copyright legal implications not understood	☐	Copyright legal implications well-considered	☐
Wider legal implications not understood	☐	Wider legal implications well-considered	☐

3. Human Centred Design Techniques Portfolio

The DRP project is a vehicle for students to explore design methods and tools in order to inspire new thinking and develop digital innovation, always with the aim of creating new and improved experiences for people, whatever the context. This portfolio should be an engaging and visual representation of your approach, illustrating your team's use of Human Centred Design techniques at each stage of your project, your reflections on what you learned and how this contributed to the ongoing development of your digital touchpoint.

We suggest you include the design methods and approaches you've used throughout the project, with reflection on how these helped guide you in your work. This should include any completed templates and tools that you have used from the DRP Playbook throughout the project. However, please note that we are looking for 'good use' of these methods, rather than the volume of such materials. We want you to clearly illustrate what you've learned and how it has evolved your thinking in the ultimate design of your digital touchpoint, as well as the impact that this has had on your audience.

For example:

- AEIOU of Field Research (Activities, Environments, Interactions, Objects, Users) and how this helped you to understand what's happening in a particular environment
- User Personas (or similar) used for storytelling
- Stakeholder Maps (highlighting different user groups)
- User Journey Maps (the before experience and after experience)
- Any Blueprints that help you visualise the different layers of an experience (people, activities, touchpoints, feelings, etc...)
- The Different Prototyping Techniques used at each stage of the project
- Testing Plan Canvas
- Cover Story mock-up (demonstrating the wider impact of your proposition)

Human Centred Design Techniques Portfolio			
People			
Missing	Poorly defined target audience lacking specific focus or well-defined characters.	Generic and non-specific people or personas.	Clear understanding and empathy illustrating the needs/behaviours of the target audience in your chosen context.
Missing	Lack of awareness of other stakeholder groups who are relevant to the chosen context and whose needs and behaviours should be considered.	High level understanding of stakeholder groups, but not enough detail to help with meaningful design decisions.	Clear understanding of relevant stakeholder groups whose needs and behaviours should be considered in your proposition.
Current/Future State (what's happening now vs the preferred, future experience)			
Missing	Current state not understood, or missing important elements.	Some representation, but lacking in-depth knowledge that connects with your idea.	Design methods used illustrate clear evidence of understanding the current state.
Missing	Insights lack authenticity and don't connect with a compelling design solution (future experience).	Insights appear authentic, but fail to resonate with your design solution (future experience).	Insights generated are empathetic and clearly create a high impact solution.
Missing	Generic/High-level opportunity statement, that doesn't relate to the scenario explored.	The opportunity statement doesn't link well with the insights that were generated.	Clear opportunity statement considering the needs of all stakeholder groups.
Testing and Validation			
Missing	Little or no evidence of user feedback impact.	Feedback represented, but no clear connection between the changes made and their impact.	Clear evidence of user feedback leading to a richer and improved experience.
Missing	Evolution of digital touchpoint missing or poorly documented.	Clear approach to testing (from concept, to feature, to experience), but lacking authentic connection to the context.	Visual representation of digital touchpoint evolution (from concept, to feature, to seamless and richer experience) showing authentic builds.
Missing	No meaningful reflection on the reason for changes in the digital touchpoint.	Some reflections but not representing a consistent approach.	Insightful reflection on what led to distinct changes in the digital touchpoint.
Understanding Impact			
Missing	Impact of new digital touchpoint on target audience poorly considered.	Some consideration of impact made, but not fully explored or superficial.	Meaningful evidence, clearly showing a better outcome for the target audience.
Missing	Impact on and experience of other stakeholder groups not considered.	The impact created for different stakeholder groups is considered to some degree, but not fully.	Meaningful evidence, clearly leading to an improved experience for all relevant stakeholder groups.